Definition of Ready (DOR)

Definition of Ready (DoR) for a Scrum Team

The **Definition of Ready (DoR)** ensures that Product Backlog Items (PBIs), such as user stories, tasks, or bugs, are fully prepared before being pulled into a Sprint. This prevents ambiguity, reduces wasted effort, and ensures smoother Sprint execution.

A Scrum Team considers a User Story "Ready" when it meets the following criteria:

1. Clear & Well-Defined

✅ The user story follows the **INVEST** principle (Independent, Negotiable, Valuable, Estimable, Small, Testable).
✅ The story is well-articulated and easily understandable by the Development Team.
✅ The story follows the **standard format**:
"As a [user], I want [feature] so that [benefit]."

2. Acceptance Criteria are Defined

✅ The story includes clear **Acceptance Criteria** that outline what needs to be done for the story to be considered complete.
✅ Acceptance Criteria are testable and align with business requirements.

3. Dependencies are Addressed

✅ All internal and external dependencies are identified and managed.
✅ If dependencies exist, there is a plan to resolve them before development starts.

4. Estimated & Feasible

✅ The story is **sized and estimated** by the Scrum Team (using story points, T-shirt sizing, etc.).
✅ The story is **small enough to be completed within a single Sprint** (typically one or a few days of effort).

5. Testability is Defined

✅ The story has clear test scenarios, ensuring it can be verified through manual or automated testing.
✅ Non-functional requirements (e.g., performance, security) are considered if applicable.

6. Business Value is Identified

✅ The Product Owner has clearly articulated the business value and priority of the story.
✅ The story aligns with the Sprint Goal and overall Product Roadmap.

7. UI/UX and Technical Details are Considered

✅ If applicable, wireframes, mockups, or design assets are attached.
✅ Technical constraints, architecture considerations, and API contracts are identified.

8. No Blockers Exist

✅ There are no unresolved questions or blockers that would prevent the team from working on the story.

9. Product Owner Approval

✅ The **Product Owner has reviewed and accepted** the story for Sprint Planning.

Example DoR Checklist for a Scrum Team:

Criteria	✅ / ❌ (Met / Not Met)
Story follows the INVEST principle	✅ ❌
Acceptance Criteria are well-defined	✅ ❌
Dependencies are identified & addressed	✅ ❌
Story is estimated & small enough for a Sprint	✅ ❌
Test scenarios are defined	✅ ❌
Business value is clear	✅ ❌
UI/UX requirements are included (if applicable)	✅ ❌

No blockers exist	✅ ❌
Approved by the Product Owner	✅ ❌

If all these conditions are met, the story is **READY** to be worked on in a Sprint. 🚀